Books & Culture CA

> **Priority B** Most years there is at least one book–author or culture current-affairs question.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Book title?	Exact title
Author?	Exact name
Any award link?	Booker, Jnanpith, Sahitya, Nobel
Any heritage site in news?	Place + what is being developed

January 2026

No strong standalone book–author question was locked for January.

Culture-linked Padma names such as Dharmendra, Mammootty, Alka Yagnik, and N Rajam are under Awards.

February 2026

Creative economy and heritage from the Budget

Orange Economy / AVGC

- AVGC means Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, and Comics.
- The Budget supported Content Creator Labs and the **Indian Institute of Creative Technologies, Mumbai**.
- More money detail → Economy.

Heritage sites

- The Budget proposed development of **15 archaeological sites**.
- Two UP names often listed in explainers are **Sarnath (Varanasi)** and **Hastinapur (Meerut)**.

Ayurveda and traditional medicine

- **3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda** were proposed.
- The **WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre** at **Jamnagar** is to be upgraded.

Soft culture notes

- India participation messaging for the **61st Venice Biennale** appeared in February coverage.
- Magh Mela 2026 in UP may appear as a soft culture or management question.

March 2026

Sahityotsav / Festival of Letters 2026 | 30 March – 4 April 2026 | New Delhi

What happened Sahitya Akademi's annual literature festival — **Sahityotsav / Festival of Letters 2026** — ran from **30 March to 4 April 2026** at the **Rabindra Bhavan** complex, New Delhi (Ministry of Culture / Sahitya Akademi).

Core facts

- English identity of the festival: **Festival of Letters** (not "Festival of poetry / story / folklore" as the sole label).
- Dates: **30 March – 4 April 2026**.
- Venue memory: Rabindra Bhavan, New Delhi.

> **Trap**

Theme distractors (poetry / story / folklore) lose to **Festival of Letters**.

Book prize

- **William Dalrymple** won the Mark Lynton History Prize for **The Golden Road: How Ancient India Transformed the World**.
- Full easy card → Awards.

Soft film fact

- Oscar season coverage mentioned Indian film **Homebound** in the International Feature conversation.

April 2026

Tides of Time murals book

What happened Coverage highlighted **Tides of Time: Bharat's History through Murals in Parliament**, linked with author **Sudha Murty** and an unveiling connected with Vice President **C. P. Radhakrishnan**.

Soft culture follow-ups

- Keep Padma 2026 conferment ceremony timing (usually March/April at Rashtrapati Bhavan) as a soft ceremony fact; the **announcement** was in January.
- Femina Miss India World 2026 winner card → Awards.

May 2026

International Booker Prize book

- Winner book: **Taiwan Travelogue**.
- Author: **Yáng Shuāng-zǐ**; translator: **Lin King**.
- Full award card → Awards.

Soft Indian book note

- Coverage named **Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav** by **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** (Agriculture Minister). Keep only as a soft personality–book hybrid.

June 2026

The Second Orbit | Shubhanshu Shukla

What happened Coverage highlighted the memoir **The Second Orbit: Belief of a Man… Dreams of 1.4 Billion Hearts** by Group Captain **Shubhanshu Shukla**.

Core facts

- He is remembered as the first Indian citizen to go to the **International Space Station** (Axiom-4 mission).
- The book covers his path from IAF fighter pilot to astronaut.

Soft culture book

- **Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto** (English idea: Bhawaiya cultural history) by Dr Jayanta Kumar Roy and Sangita Roy — folk music of North Bengal / Assam.

Soft film festival

- **19th Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF)** for non-feature films. Details → National.

July 2026

Soft National Film Awards culture fact

July award compilations recycled Best Film / Actor / Actress names from the National Film Awards cycle. Confirm the official PIB list before locking any one film as “Best Feature”.

Soft sports–culture crossover

Commonwealth Games cultural branding (Glasgow unicorn mascot **Finnie**) sits under Sports.

August 2026

Vande Mataram @ 150 years

What happened Independence Day 2026 marked **150 years** of the national song **Vande Mataram**.

Core facts

- Composer: **Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay**.
- First published: **1875** in *Bangadarshan*; later in novel **Anandamath** (**1882**).
- Equal honour with the National Anthem was affirmed in **1950**.
- First official Red Fort I-Day band performance of the song in 2026.

Soft beauty / pageant culture

Miss Universe India 2026 winner card → Awards.

October 2026

5 New Classical Languages (Total Reaches 11) | Cultural & Literary Architecture

What happened On **3 October 2026**, the Union Cabinet approved the granting of **Classical Language (शास्त्रीय भाषा)** status to **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali**.

India’s 11 Classical Languages & Literary Lineage

Classical Language	Year Conferred	Earliest Antiquity & Literary Monuments
Tamil	**2004**	Sangam literature (*Tolkappiyam*, *Silappadikaram*). First language granted status.
Sanskrit	**2005**	Vedic Samhitas, Upanishads, Valmiki Ramayana, and classical epics.
Telugu	**2008**	Inscriptions dating from 1st century CE; *Andhra Mahabharatam* by Nannaya (11th c.).
Kannada	**2008**	Halmidi inscription (c. 450 CE); *Kavirajamarga* by Amoghavarsha I (9th c.).
Malayalam	**2013**	Vazhappally copper plate (c. 830 CE); *Ramacharitam* (12th c.).
Odia	**2014**	Udayagiri-Khandagiri inscriptions (Hathigumpha inscription of Kharavela, 2nd c. BCE).
Marathi	**2026**	Inscriptions dating to 3rd century BCE (Naneghat); *Dnyaneshwari* (1290 CE) by Sant Dnyaneshwar.
Pali	**2026**	Canonical language of Theravada Buddhism; *Tipitaka* (Vinaya, Sutta, Abhidhamma Pitakas).
Prakrit	**2026**	Ancient vernacular of Ashokan rock edicts; sacred canon of Jainism (*Agamas*), *Gaha Sattasai*.
Assamese	**2026**	*Charyapada* mystic poetry (8th–12th c.); Buranjis (Ahom court chronicles) and Borgeets.
Bengali	**2026**	*Charyapada* (earliest Bengali literature); medieval Vaishnava Padavali and Mangalkavyas.

Constitutional & Language Traps for UPPCS 1. **Classical Languages vs Eighth Schedule:** - **Eighth Schedule:** Lists **22 languages** recognized under Articles 344(1) and 351 of the Constitution. - **Classical Languages:** Administrative and cultural designation granted by the Central Government via the Ministry of Culture (**11 languages**). - **Key Distinction: Pali and Prakrit are Classical Languages, but neither is listed in the 22 Eighth Schedule languages!** 2. **Hindi:** Hindi is the official language of the Union under **Article 343(1)** and is in the Eighth Schedule, but **NOT** a Classical Language.

Cultural Festivals & Heritage Milestones | October 2026

- **Ayodhya Deepotsav 2026:** Dual Guinness World Records: **26,17,215 earthen diyas** lit across **56 ghats** of the Saryu River, and **2,128 priests** in a synchronized Maha Aarti (first Deepotsav after the consecration of Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Temple).
- **Bathukamma Floral Festival (Telangana):** Celebrated across Telangana for 9 days, climaxing on *Saddula Bathukamma* (honouring Mother Goddess Gauri with intricate floral conical stacks of seasonal wild flowers).
- **Kati Bihu / Kongali Bihu (Assam):** Observed in mid-October with the lighting of earthen lamps (*saki*) at the foot of household sacred Tulsi plants, granaries (*bharal ghar*), and lush paddy fields to protect crops from pestilence.

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. With reference to the International Booker Prize 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The winning book was *Taiwan Travelogue* by Yáng Shuāng-zǐ.
2. Lin King was associated with the winning work as translator.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Awards — International Booker 2026 winner pair. **Ans: C.** Author + translator both matter in Booker stems (as in 2025 Banu Mushtaq / Deepa Bhasthi pattern).

Q2. With reference to William Dalrymple's 2026 prize coverage, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. He won the Mark Lynton History Prize for *The Golden Road*.
2. The book's subtitle idea links ancient India's global transformative role.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Dalrymple book–prize pair. **Ans: C.** Book + award. Trap: writing Booker instead of Mark Lynton.

Q3. With reference to *Tides of Time: Bharat's History through Murals in Parliament*, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Coverage linked the work with author Sudha Murty.
2. An unveiling connection with Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan appeared in coverage.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Tides of Time / Sudha Murty Parliament murals book. **Ans: C.** Soft book–ceremony fact. Trap: assigning a wrong Cabinet author.

Q4. With reference to *The Second Orbit* (June 2026 coverage), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The memoir is by Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla.
2. He is remembered as the first Indian citizen to go to the International Space Station (Axiom-4 mission) in coverage.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Second Orbit / Shubhanshu Shukla. **Ans: C.** Book–astronaut hybrid. Trap: writing Rakesh Sharma as ISS citizen fact.

Q5. With reference to Vande Mataram @ 150 years (August 2026), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The song was composed by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay.
2. It was first published in 1875 in *Bangadarshan* and later appeared in *Anandamath* (1882).
3. Equal honour with the National Anthem was affirmed in 1950.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Vande Mataram @ 150 — composer / years. **Ans: D.** Culture CA must-score for I-Day year. Trap: writing Rabindranath Tagore as composer.

Q6. With reference to Budget 2026–27 culture messaging, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. AVGC means Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming and Comics.
2. Explainers often named Sarnath (Varanasi) and Hastinapur (Meerut) among archaeological site development ideas.
3. AVGC support was limited only to film censor board reform.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Orange Economy / AVGC + UP heritage sites in Budget. **Ans: A.** (3) invents a fake limit. Trap: expanding AVGC into “all creative arts” without the four letters.

Q7. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Winning book: Taiwan Travelogue.
2. Author Yáng Shuāng-zǐ; translator Lin King.
3. Author William Dalrymple.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Booker Taiwan Travelogue. **Ans: A.** Dalrymple is Mark Lynton.

Q8. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav by Shivraj Singh Chouhan is a soft book note.
2. It won the International Booker Prize.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Apnapan soft Chouhan book. **Ans: D.** Soft only.

Q9. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar… Bhawaiya cultural history appears as soft culture book.

2. It is linked with North Bengal / Assam folk music.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Bhawaiya cultural history soft. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q10. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. India participation messaging for 61st Venice Biennale appeared in February coverage.
2. Magh Mela 2026 in UP may appear as soft culture/management CA.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Venice Biennale soft Feb. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q11. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Budget supported Indian Institute of Creative Technologies, Mumbai.
2. AVGC = Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, Comics.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: IICT Mumbai AVGC. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q12. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Budget proposed development of 15 archaeological sites.
2. Sarnath and Hastinapur often listed in UP explainers.
3. Only Taj Mahal was listed.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: 15 archaeological sites Budget. **Ans: A.** (3) false.

Q13. With reference to Vande Mataram, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Later appeared in novel Anandamath (1882).
2. Composer Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay.
3. Composer Rabindranath Tagore.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Anandamath 1882 fact. **Ans: A.** Tagore = Jana Gana Mana.

Q14. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Equal honour with National Anthem affirmed in 1950.

2. First published 1875 in Bangadarshan.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Equal honour 1950. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q15. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Homebound mentioned in Oscar International Feature conversation.
2. MIFF 19th Mumbai International Film Festival for non-feature films soft note.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Homebound Oscar soft. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q16. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. CWG Glasgow unicorn mascot Finnie is a sports–culture crossover fact.
2. Finnie is the International Booker winner.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Finnie culture crossover. **Ans: D.** (2) false.

Q17. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Mammootty and Alka Yagnik are Padma culture names cross-linked from Awards.
2. N Rajam (UP) is Padma Vibhushan Art.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Padma culture names Mammootty Alka. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q18. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Shubhanshu Shukla memoir The Second Orbit.
2. First Indian citizen to ISS (Axiom-4) in coverage.
3. First Indian in space overall (replacing Rakesh Sharma).

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Second Orbit ISS Axiom-4. **Ans: A.** Citizen/ISS fact ≠ first Indian in space.

Q19. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Tides of Time linked with Sudha Murty.
2. Parliament murals history theme.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Tides of Time Sudha Murty. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q20. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. 3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda proposed.
2. WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre Jamnagar to be upgraded.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: 3 AIIA + Jamnagar WHO. **Ans: C.** Both true — culture/health hybrid.